



COMIC CHALLENGE!

-
- A map of the West Valley area showing the locations of Community Corner. The map includes major roads like I-405, I-15, and SR-153, as well as local roads like Redwood Rd, Lone Tree Rd, and Lone Tree Blvd. Several locations are marked with purple triangles and labeled 'COMMUNITY CORNER'. These locations are distributed across the valley, including near the airport, in the northern part, and in the southern part. The map also shows various landmarks like the airport, the city of West Valley, and the city of Sandy.

A purple mailbox with a red flag is shown on a wooden post. A yellow envelope is visible inside the mailbox.

Make sure to shovel out nearby fire hydrants after snowfall. Clear at least a 3-foot radius around the hydrant and a path to the street—this ensures firefighters can quickly locate and access it in an emergency, potentially saving minutes that could prevent a small fire from becoming catastrophic.

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MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh

Parshas Vaera. Perek 8. Pasuk 8.

In this pasuk Moshe prays to Hashem to remove the frogs. The question is, why was Moshe able to pray and remove the frogs whereas in parshas Chukas when Hashem sent the snakes against Bnei Yisroel, Moshe was unable to pray and remove the snakes? The only thing he could do was make a bronze staff with a snake around it to cure anyone who was bitten by the snake.

The answer is that with every sin we do, a "prosecutor" is created. The sin that was done in parshas Chukas was lashon hara (evil speech). All other "prosecuting angels" that were created from sins don't actually speak; their mere existence is the prosecution. The "prosecuting angel" from lashon hara, however, speaks and continues to prosecute. Therefore, the snakes in parshas Chukas could not simply be removed as they represented "prosecuting angels" which could not be ignored as they are actively prosecuting. Therefore, the only thing that could be done was to get healed from the snake bites. (Chafetz Chaim)

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COMMUNITY CORNER

PARSHAS

VA'ERA
וארא



SHABBOS STARTS: **4:35 PM**
(18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS: **5:44 PM**
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: **6:05 PM**
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern
Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.



STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



It happened once that some Chasidim of the Baal Shem Tov were sitting and farbrenging together. The longer they shared their stories and insights and sang their Chasidic melodies, the stronger their desire to be with the Baal Shem Tov grew, till they impulsively decided to hire a horse and wagon and set out for the Baal Shem Tov's town of Mezhibozh.

Their own shtetl was actually quite a distance from Mezhibozh; even if they traveled non-stop for several days, there was only a small chance they might make it before Shabbat. The wagon driver was less than enthusiastic; as far as he was concerned there was no need to hurry, and in his opinion, it was simply not possible to cover that many miles before sundown on Friday. The roads were very bad, he pointed out, and there were always unexpected obstacles and delays while traveling.

But the Chasidim could not be deterred. Logical considerations could not compete with their intense longing to see their Rebbe. Without further ado they were on their way.

The wagon driver soon had the horses at a gallop, running as fast as they could under the circumstances. The roads were very narrow, wide enough for only one vehicle. They were so narrow, in fact, that if another vehicle were to appear, passing it on either side would be impossible.

As the Chasidim reached a fork in the road, at an intersection where another path joined the main thoroughfare, an elegant carriage suddenly pulled out in front of them. It was the carriage of the local poritz (landowner), and he was clearly in no hurry to go anywhere. At a leisurely pace his carriage ambled down the road, blocking all traffic. The Chasidim were now stuck behind it, reduced to a crawl.

The wagon driver gritted his teeth; even the Chasidim were becoming angry. The tiny chance they had to make it to Mezhibozh in time for Shabbat was rapidly evaporating before their eyes.

One Chasid was more upset than the others. "I can't believe it!" he complained. "After all our efforts, how can something so ridiculous spoil our plans? Just because of this slowpoke we're going to miss out on spending Shabbat with the Baal Shem Tov!"

Another Chasid, however, hastened to calm him down. "My dear brother, how can you say such a thing? Why are you worried? Have you forgotten what our master the Baal Shem Tov has taught us, that the Holy One, Blessed Be He, directly supervises every minute detail in the world, and that a leaf doesn't turn in the wind without Divine Providence? Does it not state in the Torah, 'From Him no evil will descend'? Nothing bad can come from on High, and indeed, everything is for the good. Whatever G-d does is only good and for the best. The more we accustom ourselves to thinking and acting

accordingly, the more we will merit to see the good that exists in everything openly revealed. How can it be that this basic principle should be forgotten when it comes to actually implementing it in our own lives? I tell you friend, this is only a trial..."

The Chasid's fervent plea entered the hearts of the others, and their impatience disappeared. Their wagon could still only proceed at a sluggish pace, but they were filled with renewed faith and confidence that the unexpected delay was for the best.

The wagon continued over the next few miles until suddenly, another potential problem appeared on the horizon. All the way up ahead, at the next intersection, they could see a group of drunken peasants waiting to pounce on the first wagon that passed by...

There was no doubt what the drunken peasants would have done to the Chasidim if they had been alone on the road, or traveling ahead of the poritz's carriage. No one would have stood up for the Jews or sought justice for them after the fact. They would have simply received the "usual" treatment drunken peasants knew so well how to mete out. The Chasidim would have been grateful to have escaped with their lives, let alone continue on their journey.

As it turned out, however, because the poritz's carriage was hogging the right of way, the hooligans simply dispersed once they saw whom it contained. By the time the Chasidim reached the intersection they had all slunk away and the danger was over.

A few minutes later the poritz's carriage turned off onto a side road, and the main thoroughfare was suddenly clear. With a crack of the whip the horses were again at a gallop, and the Chasidim made it to Mezhibozh before Shabbat - with plenty of time to spare. From here we learn that even something that doesn't appear to be good at first, may in fact be so in reality.

PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodtko

I outlived all my 11 brothers. Who am I?

Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

- Q. What message about the bush did Moshe understand that made him scared?
A. That he was in the presence of Hashem.

TEFILLAH OF THE WEEK

הללוהו - Hallelukah #1

Praise God! My soul, praise Hashem
I will praise Hashem with my life I will sing to my God as long as I live

Do not place your trust even in noble men

in man who has no power of deliverance

When his spirit departs he returns to his earth

on that day his plans come to naught

Fortunate is he when the Almighty of Yakov is his help

whose expectation is on Hashem his God

He makes heaven and earth the sea and all that is in them

He keeps His promises faithfully forever

He performs justice for the oppressed

He gives bread to the hungry

Hashem releases the imprisoned

Hashem gives sight to the blind

Hashem straightens the bent

Hashem loves the righteous

Hashem protects strangers

the orphan and widow He enables to stand firm

and the way of the wicked He thwarts

Hashem will reign forever your God Tzion throughout all generations Praise God



NOACH'S JOKES & RIDDLES By: Noach Isaacs

What has a neck but no head, and wears a cap?

ANSWER: A BOTTLE.



JONAH'S JEWISH JOKES By: Jonah Lenefsky

Why do Jews answer a question with a question?

Why not?



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